

## Character Moment

### INT. BLAKE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Darkness.

STATIC crackles through an old HAM RADIO.

A hand carefully turns the tuning dial.

BLAKE MERCER, 26, dark hair, tired eyes, sits hunched over a desk crowded with radio equipment.

Beside it all sits a photograph.

Two boys, maybe fifteen, grin at the camera beside a lake. One is Blake. The other is EVAN.

Blake adjusts another dial.

BLAKE  
Evan, this is Blake. Are you  
receiving me?

Static.

Blake waits.

Nothing.

He marks something in a notebook.

Frequency. Time. Weather conditions.

Pages upon pages of identical entries.

EMILY (O.S.)  
Blake?

Blake doesn't respond.

He changes frequencies.

BLAKE  
Evan, this is Blake. Are you  
receiving me?

EMILY (O.S.)  
Blake!

BLAKE  
What?

EMILY (O.S.)  
Mom said you were making dinner.

Blake looks at the clock.

8:43 P.M.

A frozen pizza box sits unopened beside his bedroom door.

BLAKE

Crap.

Blake starts to get up.

STATIC POPS from the radio.

He freezes.

Slowly sits back down.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Evan?

Nothing.

Blake leans closer.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Evan, can you hear me?

EMILY, 11, appears in the doorway.

EMILY

I'm starving.

Blake raises a finger.

Wait.

Emily rolls her eyes.

Blake listens.

Only static.

EMILY (CONT'D)

He's not going to answer.

Blake looks at her.

A beat.

BLAKE

Pizza's by the door.

EMILY

You're supposed to make it.

BLAKE  
You know how to use the oven.

EMILY  
Mom said I'm not supposed to when  
nobody's downstairs.

BLAKE  
I'm upstairs.

EMILY  
Exactly.

Blake looks back toward the radio.

Emily watches him.

EMILY (CONT'D)  
How long are you gonna keep doing  
this?

BLAKE  
Doing what?

She gestures to everything.

The radio.

The notebooks.

The photograph.

EMILY  
This.

Blake turns another dial.

BLAKE  
Five more minutes.

EMILY  
You said that an hour ago.

Blake doesn't answer.

Emily grabs the pizza.

EMILY (CONT'D)  
Fine.

She disappears down the hall.

Blake looks after her.

Guilt.

He takes off his headphones and starts to stand.

A faint sound slips through them.

Blake stops.

He slowly puts them back on.

STATIC.

Then-

Something underneath it.

A voice?

Blake leans toward the radio.

BLAKE

Evan?

Nothing.

Blake waits.

The bedroom door remains open behind him.

From downstairs-

EMILY (O.S.)

Blake! How long do I put it in for?

Blake closes his eyes.

He looks toward the hallway.

Then back to the radio.

He switches it off.

Silence.

BLAKE

Coming!

Blake gets up.

As he passes the photograph, he stops.

Straightens it.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Tomorrow.

He leaves.

The bedroom sits empty.

A beat.

The radio CLICKS.

Its display illuminates by itself.

STATIC fills the room.

Buried somewhere deep beneath it --

VOICE (V.O.)

...Blake...

CUT TO BLACK.

## Jumpscare scene

INT. GAS STATION - NIGHT

Blake and Emily enter the gas station slowly, the fluorescent lights flicker over head. Blake looks around cautiously before turning toward Emily and kneeling down

BLAKE

Listen EM, I'm going to look for,..  
whatever it is we need to find ok?  
I want you to hide

EMILY

I can help!

BLAKE

If you notice anything, let me  
know, but we have no idea what is  
going on here. Your safety is my  
priority

He hugs his little sister and leads her to the counter

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Wait here, I'll be back soon

Blake turns to the dilapidated shelves, and ventures into the aisles.

The lights continue to flicker periodically, they provide just enough light to navigate, but not enough to make out much detail.

Blake moves cautiously between the shelves.

His flashlight sweeps over dusty cans, expired snacks, and shattered glass. He steps on the glass and the silence is broken by the CRUNCH.

Nothing.

The fluorescent lights BUZZ.

FLICK.

Darkness.

FLICK.

Back on.

Blake freezes.

One of the shelves at the end of the aisle is slightly out of place, he doesn't remember it being there.

He slowly approaches.

Another FLICKER.

Darkness.

A loud metallic CLANG echoes from somewhere deeper in the store, Blake spins toward the sound.

Silence.

He waits.

Nothing.

He turns back,.

A MAN stands inches from his face.

His body is perfectly still.

His head is twisted completely backwards.

Milky white eyes stare directly into Blake's as he falls back in terror

BLAKE (CONT'D)  
(yelling)  
Jesus!

Blake on the ground stares at the man as lights FLICK back on, and the man doesn't react.

## Midpoint

### **INT. EVAN'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT**

Blake pushes open the bedroom door.

He stops.

Unlike the rest of the decaying house, this room is untouched.

Posters cover the walls. Clothes litter the floor. A stack of CDs sits beside an ancient stereo.

A room frozen ten years in the past.

Blake steps inside.

On the desk sits a HAM RADIO.

The same model Blake had as a kid.

He approaches it slowly.

**BLAKE**

No way.

The radio CLICKS on.

STATIC.

Then-

**EVAN (V.O.)**

Blake?

Blake grabs the microphone.

**BLAKE**

Evan! I'm here.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

You found it.

**BLAKE**

Is this the next one? The next anchor?

A beat.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

Yeah.

Blake looks over the radio.

A strange SYMBOL has been carved into the desk beneath it.

The same symbol from the gas station.

**BLAKE**

Okay. Tell me what to do.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

You have to destroy it.

Blake looks at the radio.

**BLAKE**

This was yours.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

It's just a radio.

That bothers Blake.

He runs his fingers across the dusty controls.

**BLAKE**

You loved this thing.

Static.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

Blake. We don't have much time.

Blake looks toward the doorway.

Emily and Noah stand watching.

**NOAH**

Maybe that's a good reason to slow down.

**BLAKE**

We know what we have to do.

**NOAH**

No. That thing knows what it wants you to do.

**BLAKE**

It's Evan.

**EMILY**

How do you know?

Blake looks at her.

**BLAKE**

Because I know him.

The radio POPS.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

Blake.

His voice is weaker now.

**EVAN (V.O.) (CONT'D)**

Please.

Blake picks up the radio.

He hesitates.

Then SLAMS it against the floor.

Once.

Twice.

On the third strike, the radio SHATTERS.

The symbol beneath the desk splits down the middle.

A deep RUMBLE passes through the house.

The bedroom lights EXPLODE.

Darkness.

Emily SCREAMS.

**BLAKE**

Emily?!

Blake fumbles for his flashlight.

It clicks on.

Emily and Noah are still in the doorway.

They're okay.

Blake exhales.

Then notices something behind them.

A BOY stands at the opposite end of the hallway.

Fifteen years old.

Soaking wet.

Blake's flashlight trembles.

**BLAKE (CONT'D)**

Evan?

The boy smiles.

Blake rushes past Emily.

**EMILY**

Blake, wait!

The boy disappears around the corner.

Blake follows.

**INT. EVAN'S HOUSE - HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS**

Blake rounds the corner.

Empty.

**BLAKE**

Evan!

His radio crackles from his pocket.

Blake pulls it out.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

You did it.

Blake laughs through tears.

**BLAKE**

I saw you.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

We're getting closer.

**BLAKE**

Tell me where you are.

Silence.

**BLAKE (CONT'D)**

Evan?

**EVAN (V.O.)**

There's one thing I haven't told you.

Blake waits.

Emily and Noah approach behind him.

**EVAN (V.O.) (CONT'D)**  
Breaking the anchors can open the  
way. But it can't bring me through.

Blake's smile fades.

**BLAKE**  
What does?

Static swells.

**EVAN (V.O.)**  
There has to be an exchange.

**BLAKE**  
An exchange?

**EVAN (V.O.)**  
A soul for a soul.

Emily looks at Blake.

**EMILY**  
No.

**EVAN (V.O.)**  
Someone living has to take my  
place.

Silence.

Noah slowly shakes his head.

**NOAH**  
We're done.

He takes Emily by the shoulder.

**NOAH (CONT'D)**  
We're leaving.

Blake doesn't move.

**EMILY**  
Blake?

Blake stares at the broken radio on the bedroom floor.

Ten years of guilt behind his eyes.

Then,...

Relief.

**BLAKE**

Okay.

Emily stares at him.

**EMILY**

What?

Blake raises the radio.

**BLAKE**

I'll do it.

**EMILY**

Blake-

**BLAKE**

It should be me.

**EMILY**

No!

Blake turns away.

**BLAKE**

Where's the next anchor?

A long beat.

Then Evan answers.

Almost tenderly.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

I knew you'd come back for me.

Blake doesn't notice the faint smile forming in Evan's voice.

Emily does.

**CUT TO BLACK.**

## Climax

### EXT. FROZEN LAKE - NIGHT

Blake stands alone at the center of the lake.

Snow whips around him.

Beneath his feet,...

FACES.

Hundreds of them suspended beneath the ice. Men. Women. Children.

All staring upward.

Blake grips his radio.

**BLAKE**

I'm here.

STATIC.

Then,

**EVAN (V.O.)**

I knew you'd come.

Blake looks across the lake.

The fog clears slightly, and we see EVAN twenty feet away, trapped in the ice. Only his head is in the air, but its too dark to make out much detail.

Fifteen years old. Soaking wet. Exactly as Blake remembers him.

**BLAKE**

Tell me what to do.

Blake steps closer.

**EVAN**

You already know.

A CRACK travels beneath Blake's feet.

**EVAN (CONT'D)**

One soul leaves.  
Another takes its place.

Blake looks down at the faces beneath him.

**BLAKE**

And you'll be free?

**EVAN**

We'll both be free.

Blake's eyes fill with tears.

He nods.

**BLAKE**

Okay.

Evan smiles.

Blake steps forward.

Then stops.

Something catches his eye.

Evan's reflection.

The boy is before him-

But reflected in the ice is something impossibly tall.

Thin.

Ancient.

Blake looks back at Evan.

**EVAN**

What's wrong?

Blake backs away.

**BLAKE**

Tell me something.

**EVAN**

Blake, we don't have time.

**BLAKE**

All these years, you've told me  
things about us.

Evan's smile fades.

**BLAKE (CONT'D)**

Things I remember.

The wind intensifies.

**BLAKE (CONT'D)**

Tell me something about you.

Silence.

**EVAN**

What?

**BLAKE**

Something I don't know.

Evan stares at him.

**BLAKE (CONT'D)**

What did you do after I went home  
the night before the lake?

**EVAN**

Blake-

**BLAKE**

What did your mom give you for your  
birthday that year?

**EVAN**

Stop.

**BLAKE**

What were you afraid of?

Evan's face twitches.

**BLAKE (CONT'D)**

You know everything about me.

Blake's voice breaks.

**BLAKE (CONT'D)**

Tell me something about you.

Evan's expression empties.

The wind stops.

Complete silence.

**EVAN**

Does it matter?

Blake stares at him.

He knows.

**BLAKE**

You're not Evan.

Evan's neck jerks sideways.

A wet CRACK.

**EVAN**

I know every word he ever spoke to you.

His voice changes.

Older.

Deeper.

Other voices whisper underneath it.

**ADVERSARY**

Every secret you shared. Every promise you broke. Every night you begged him to answer.

The ice beneath Evan DARKENS.

His reflection stretches outward.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

I know what you did.

Blake's grip tightens around the radio.

**BLAKE**

I tried to save him.

**ADVERSARY**

And yet-

The entity smiles with Evan's face.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

Here you are.

The faces beneath Blake begin to stir.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

Do you know how many have stood where you stand?

The voices beneath the ice WHISPER.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

A father who wanted his daughter back. A wife who begged for one more night. Children crying for their mothers.

The entity's voice gets louder, as the ice keeping him trapped starts to crack

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

They all came willingly.

More ice breaks.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

I did not drag you here.

Blake backs away.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

I did not bring your sister into this place.

Blake flinches.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

I did not abandon your life for ten years.

Another CRACK beneath Blake.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

You did.

Blake looks down.

His reflection stares back at him.

For a moment, he sees himself as a fifteen-year-old boy.

Terrified.

Drowning.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

You have always known what you deserve.

Evan extends a hand.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

So make it right.

Blake stares at it.

From somewhere across the lake-

**EMILY (O.S.)**

BLAKE!

He turns.

Emily stands on the distant shore.

**EMILY** (CONT'D)  
COME BACK!

Blake looks between her and Evan.

The dead.

The living.

**ADVERSARY**  
She'll understand.

Blake looks at Evan.

**ADVERSARY** (CONT'D)  
Eventually.

Blake almost takes his hand.

Then-

**BLAKE**  
No.

The entity's smile disappears.

**ADVERSARY**  
What?

**BLAKE**  
I was fifteen.

Blake lowers his hand.

**BLAKE** (CONT'D)  
I was scared.

The entity stares daggers into Blake.

**ADVERSARY**  
You left him.

**BLAKE**  
I survived.

**ADVERSARY**  
You abandoned him.

**BLAKE**  
I tried to save him.

The entity's face begins to distort.

**ADVERSARY**

He called your name.

Blake is crying now.

But he doesn't move.

**BLAKE**

I know.

A beat.

**BLAKE (CONT'D)**

And I'm sorry.

The entity smiles again.

**ADVERSARY**

Then prove it.

Blake looks toward Emily.

Then back at the thing wearing his friend's face.

**BLAKE**

I don't have to die to prove I  
loved him.

The smile vanishes.

For the first time-

The Adversary looks afraid.

Blake looks at the radio in his hand.

The last thing connecting them.

**ADVERSARY**

Blake.

Evan's voice again.

Perfect.

Frightened.

**EVAN (V.O.)**

Please.

Blake closes his eyes.

It hurts.

Then-

He SLAMS the radio against the ice.

**ADVERSARY**

NO!

Again.

The casing cracks.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

BLAKE!

Again.

The radio SHATTERS.

Silence.

A fracture races across the lake.

Then another.

And another.

The ice around the Adversary EXPLODES.

The thing wearing Evan's face tears itself free,

For the first time, Evan's face disappears.

Something enormous writhes beneath it.

Long limbs claw against the ice.

The trapped faces below open their mouths.

Hands punch through the surface.

Dozens.

Hundreds.

They seize the Adversary.

It SCREAMS in a thousand stolen voices.

**ADVERSARY (CONT'D)**

YOU CANNOT FORGIVE YOURSELF!

Blake watches.

**BLAKE**

I'm going to try.

The hands drag the Adversary beneath the surface.

Gone.

A beat.

CRACK.

Blake looks down.

The ice beneath his feet gives way.

He plunges into darkness.

**CUT TO BLACK.**

## Final

### **INT. BLAKE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT**

Quiet.

The desk is almost empty now.

The notebooks are gone. The maps and newspaper clippings have been taken down. Pale rectangles mark where they once covered the walls.

No antennas.

No receivers.

No endless sea of wires.

Only a photograph.

Two boys, maybe fifteen, grin at the camera beside a lake.

Blake and Evan.

The bedroom door opens.

**BLAKE MERCER** enters carrying a cardboard box.

He sets it on the bed.

Inside are the last pieces of radio equipment.

Blake picks up an old microphone.

Turns it over in his hand.

For a moment, he can't bring himself to put it away.

**EMILY (O.S.)**

Blake!

Blake looks toward the hallway.

**BLAKE**

Yeah?

**EMILY (O.S.)**

You said we were making dinner!

Blake looks at the microphone.

Then drops it into the box.

**BLAKE**

I'm coming.

He closes the box.

As Blake turns to leave, he notices Evan's photograph.

He picks it up.

Studies his friend's face.

A small smile.

**BLAKE** (CONT'D)

Goodnight, Evan.

Blake sets the photograph back on the desk.

He turns off the light and leaves.

**INT. KITCHEN - MOMENTS LATER**

Emily stands at the counter surrounded by ingredients.

A cookbook lies open beside her.

Blake enters.

**EMILY**

You're late.

**BLAKE**

By like thirty seconds.

**EMILY**

Still late.

Blake grabs an apron from the counter.

**BLAKE**

All right, chef. What's first?

Emily slides the cookbook toward him.

**EMILY**

You're cutting the onions.

**BLAKE**

Why do I have to cut them?

**EMILY**

Because they make me cry.

**BLAKE**

They make everyone cry.

**EMILY**

Sounds like a you problem.

Blake shakes his head.

For the first time in a long time, he laughs.

He begins chopping.

Emily works beside him.

Normal.

Quiet.

Together.

Then-

STATIC.

Blake stops.

Emily doesn't notice.

STATIC crackles faintly from somewhere down the hall.

Blake looks toward his bedroom.

A familiar voice, almost too quiet to hear --

**EVAN (O.S.)**

Still awake?

Blake's smile disappears.

The knife rests motionless against the cutting board.

Emily notices.

**EMILY**

Blake?

He stares down the hallway.

Waiting.

The static continues.

Blake could follow it.

Instead, he sets down the knife.

Looks at Emily.

**BLAKE**

Still listening?

Emily looks confused.

Then smiles.

**EMILY**

Always.

Blake smiles back.

He returns to the onions.

From down the hall-

STATIC.

Then silence.

Blake keeps chopping.

**FADE OUT.**

**THE END**